MESSERSCHMIEDE

INTERVENTION / PERFORMANCE, FRANKFURT, 2017



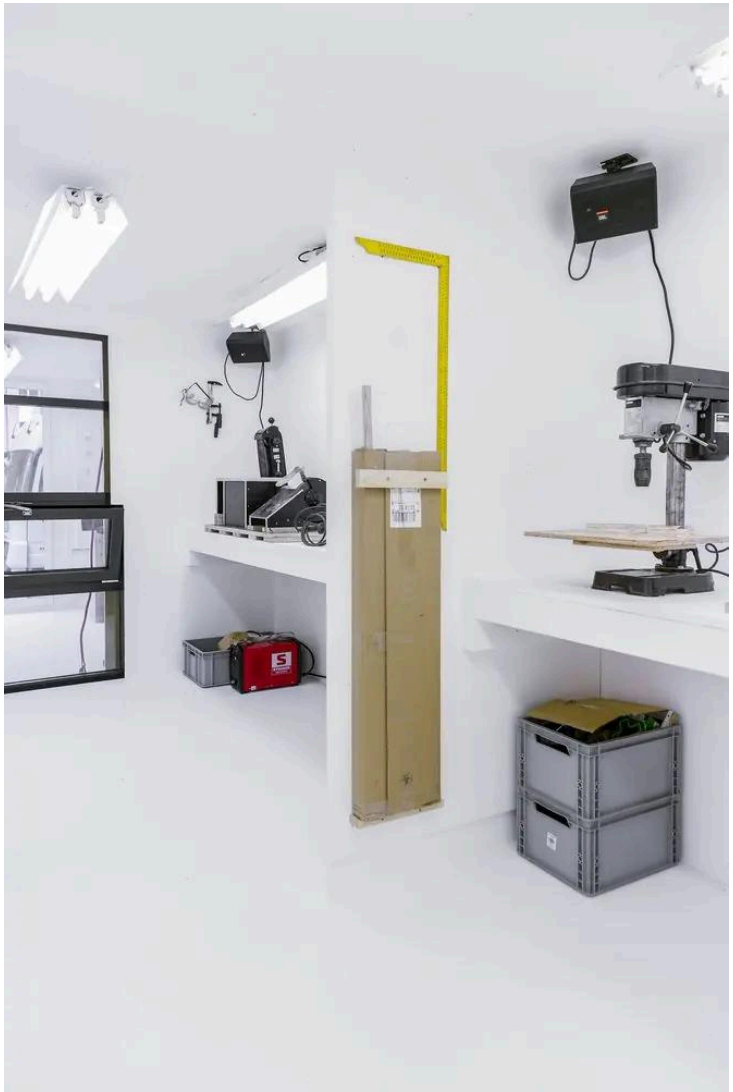
Messerschmiede (2017) Frankfurt

The two-year collaboration between YRD.Works and Künstlerhaus Mousonturm opened with the installation Messerschmiede (Knife Forge), on view in 2017 inside and outside the Mousonturm. Like a parasite nesting in the theatre's architecture, the collective occupied the restaurant and part of the outdoor grounds with a 12-metre-long box housing the forge. There, within fourteen days, they produced an edition of 100 handmade knives, each numbered with a stamped combination of digits and letters.

The rectangular sculpture consisted of four areas marking different steps of knife production. The first zone was outdoors, where visitors could watch the artists working the knife blanks through glazed openings. The adjoining room formed a fluid transition into the restaurant; it served for further processing of the metal and could also be viewed through glass. In the next section, the ground knives were fitted with wooden handles, and in the last room they were presented as finished products ready for sale.

The small temporary factory inevitably drew visitors to the Mousonturm into knife production and made them part of the two-week performance. During this time, the artists took on the role of craftsmen and staged their short-lived production site in an unvarnished version that revealed technical and production-related details. Showing the step-by-step making of a knife brought into focus not only questions about the production of objects but also the ambivalent character of the knife as both tool and weapon.

So were handmade everyday objects or limited artworks being made in the Messerschmiede? And was this an artistic performance or a commercial pop-up shop? In their performative intervention, YRD.Works question not only common systems of producing and valuing art but also their economic and social rules.



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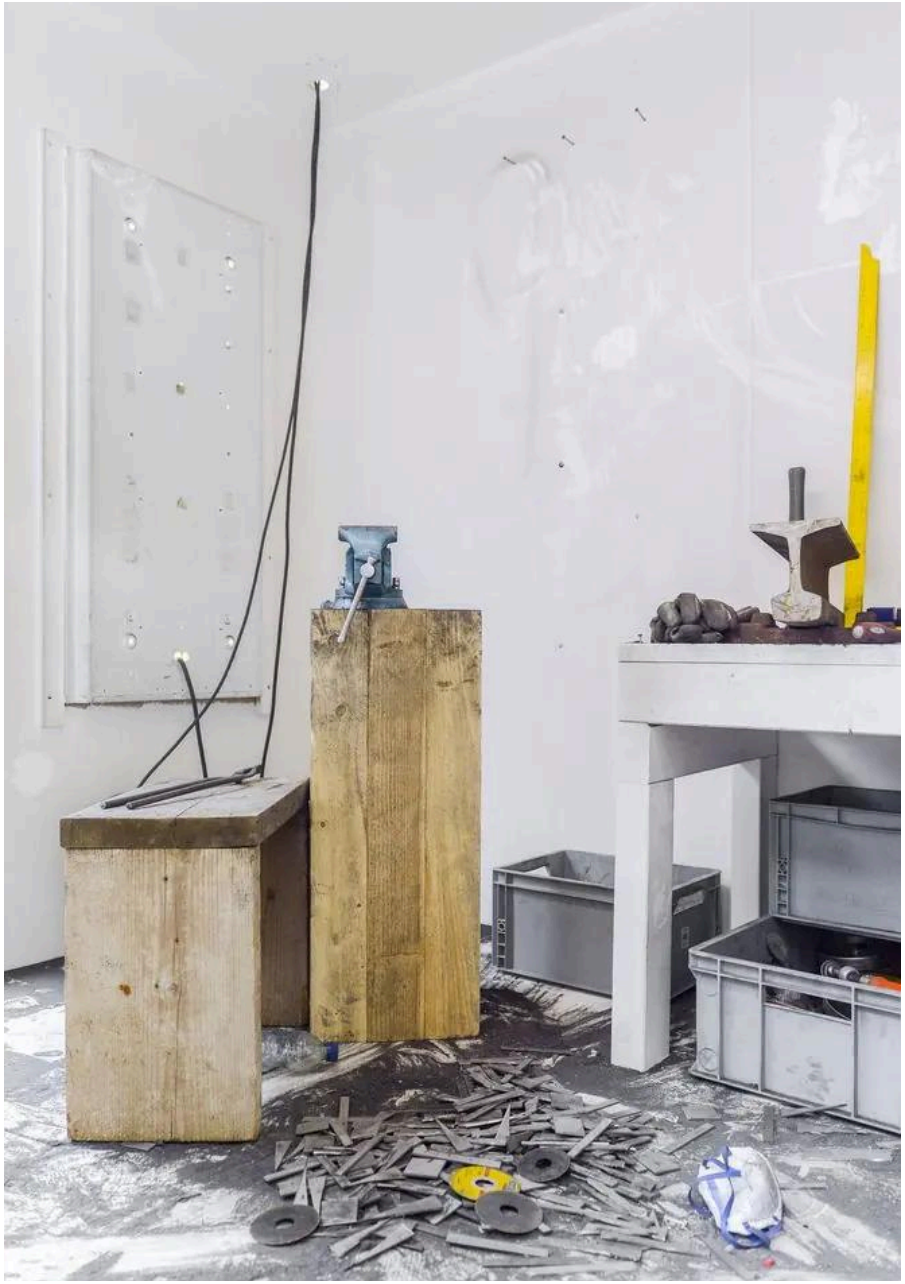


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